Repeat Requests for Adminship

Network change, prior outcomes and later success

Group project brief | 26 October 2026

PROPOSAL DRAFTED

PROJECT STATUS
The proposal has been drafted and preliminary data feasibility checks are complete. It has not yet been submitted or approved.

Research question

Among repeat Requests for Adminship candidates, how do changes in voter-community composition, support-coalition overlap and network position differ between previously rejected and previously successful candidates, and how are these changes associated with the next outcome?

Project at a glance

198,275	11,381	414
raw vote records	voters and candidates	repeat candidates

394 previously rejected | **29** previously successful | **9** both outcomes

What we have completed

- Reviewed the project requirements and prior research on Wikipedia elections.
- Identified repeat candidacy, support-coalition change and network position as a focused gap that builds on the course material.
- Downloaded and audited the primary Stanford SNAP wiki-RfA dataset and the companion election-outcome dataset.
- Checked that enough repeated attempts exist for analysis, including both previously rejected and previously successful candidates.
- Drafted the research question, data description and a concise R-based methodology.

Data sources

Source	File and size	Coverage	Role
Stanford SNAP wiki-RfA	wiki-RfA.txt.gz 14,970,777 bytes	2003 - May 2013	Primary vote and comment data
Stanford SNAP wiki-Elec	wikiElec.ElecBs3.txt.gz 1,090,375 bytes	2,794 elections through Jan. 2008	Outcome validation

AUDIT FLAG
The raw primary file contains duplicate vote rows, conflicting result labels and missing dates. Records will be deduplicated, outcomes validated and unresolved cases reported as ambiguous.

Analysis plan in four steps

1	**Prepare the data.** Parse the two files, normalise usernames, remove duplicate votes and reconstruct separate attempts using voting dates. Validate outcomes and mark unresolvable cases.
2	**Build the network.** Users are nodes. A vote from a voter to a candidate is a directed edge. Support and opposition are represented separately.
3	**Measure change.** Identify voter communities from prior co-voting behaviour, then compare supporter overlap, new supporters, community diversity, centrality and brokerage between attempts.
4	**Study the outcome.** Compare descriptive changes by previous result, then use a parsimonious logistic regression for the later outcome. All predictors use only information available before that attempt begins.

No leakage: voting behaviour from attempt t+1 will never be used as a predictor of whether attempt t+1 succeeds. Those variables are used only for descriptive comparison.

Tool: the complete analysis will be implemented in R, using igraph for network analysis and ggplot2 for visualisation. Results will be described as associations, not causal effects.

Work plan and responsibilities

Workstream	Lead	Deliverable
Data preparation and outcome validation	Data member	Clean attempt-level dataset and documented validation log
Network analysis and modelling	Network member	Network measures, statistical results and main figures
Literature, interpretation and report	Joint	Five or more references, discussion, limitations and contribution paragraph
Code review and oral presentation	Joint	Reproducible R package and seven-minute presentation

Submission requirements

- Final report: 12,000 - 20,000 characters including spaces.
- Maximum four figures or tables, each captioned and referenced.
- At least five scientific references and a contribution paragraph.
- PDF report with no code; separate tested R code and required data.
- All group members participate in the seven-minute project discussion.
- The 30% theoretical oral exam must be passed before the project discussion.

Immediate next steps

Now	Both members review and agree on the proposal; submit it through Moodle.
After approval	Finalise the cleaned attempt-level dataset and begin the main R pipeline.
Analysis	Build and test the network analysis, statistical comparison and four final figures.
Before submission	Complete the report, contribution paragraph, references and reproducibility checks.
2 Nov 2026	Upload report, code and data by 09:00 CET; email the instructor to confirm.

Primary sources
SNAP wiki-RfA: https://snap.stanford.edu/data/wiki-RfA.html
SNAP wiki-Elec: https://snap.stanford.edu/data/wiki-Elec.html

Key caveat
The repeated-success group is small (about 29). It will be treated as a secondary descriptive comparison, while the main analysis focuses on all validated repeat candidates.